



Your Time on Facebook

Facebook started rolling out its "Your Time on Facebook" feature to help you keep track of usage. <https://dgit.in/dec18-18-1>



BMW ride-hailing service

Germany's BMW allegedly plans to launch a ride-hailing service in China by December. <https://dgit.in/dec18-18-2>

GUIDE TO IDENTIFYING FAKE VIDEOS

With fake videos powered by powerful, accessible technology rampant on the internet, here's a guide to help you distinguish the real deal from the fake

Arnab Mukherjee | arnab@digit.in

Even before the cutting edge technology of today was available, fake news in the form of falsified images and edited videos was a big problem for society. Today, thanks to the prowess of artificial intelligence and machine learning, a computer application can be used to produce fakes that are near indistinguishable from the real deal. A most notable example of this technology is the Deepfake, which works on popular AI libraries like Tensorflow. We've seen examples of world leaders morphed into saying things they never said, fake pornographic material and so on. The capabilities of this technology are endless, and they're only getting better every day.

The key phrase in the introductory paragraph of this article was *near* indistinguishable. Yes, it is not impossible to identify these fakes. There are certain characteristics that the naked eye and human brain can still catch. Additionally, there is technology in the works to detect them with higher accuracy than any human cognitive system can.

STEP 1: COMMON SENSE

When faced with a video on the internet that is unlikely to be real, common

sense dictates that it almost certainly a fake. Did Nicholas Cage ever really shoot for Lois Lane in Man of Steel? Did a multi-millionaire celebrity who is also a noted feminist really shoot a risque video for the internet? The answers to these questions that come from your gut are mostly also the truth. If such a video were to be real, there would be corroborating coverage across the internet that would verify its authenticity. A couple of tips along these lines:

- If the video is super blurry, very low resolution, shot in poor light, features a location between buildings or obscured by trees, it shouldn't be trusted for authenticity.
- If the camera is perfectly still for a video that the shooter just happened to record, it is likely that they had a tripod and that this was a planned fake.



It doesn't take anything more than common sense to know that this is fake

STEP 2: VISUAL CUES

This is where most of the action is. There are numerous things that we subconsciously observe in our day to day lives, as well as when we watch authentic videos. When a potentially fake video falls short on these signs, it registers in our brain and generates an uncanny feeling. Some of these signs and the reasons behind them are:

- **Staring match:** in many cases, the software that generates fake videos where the face of one person is superimposed onto another person's body takes the source face data from huge datasets of photographs. These datasets are procured from the internet and have one particular flaw that makes the fakes easier to detect – almost all photos have people with their eyes open. People don't generally save those botched selfies or groupies where someone blinked. Hence, an AI trained on this data creates a visual where the target individual seems to be in an eternal staring match with an unknown contender.